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Culture (OWC): [Fur \(MQ08\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1879-1885

Coverage Date: 1879 AD - 1885 AD

Place Coverage: Darfur Region, Sudan

Section Title(S): Monday, 6th July 1885.

Supper, like breakfast, consists of porridge and milk; roasted meat, stews, and vegetables are added to create variety. Water is almost invariably drunk with food; beer and wine are drunk between meals, the only exception being at great feasts, when they are immoderately consumed.

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Feasts take place at births, weddings, and at the great yearly religious festival. At funerals there is a solemn meal, when laughter and jokes are unheard. A description of these will be given later on.

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On occasions of rejoicing a man will call his friends together to drink with him. Friends are well looked after at meals, tit-bits often being presented to them. Meat is sometimes ready cut into small pieces before being placed on the dish; sometimes, however, it is served in joints; occasionally also a sheep is served entire. In this case one of the party, generally a young man, carves for everybody; otherwise each person helps himself. The older people always take food out of the dish first, for though visitors are requested to begin, they would be considered very rude if they did so before older persons than themselves; the same custom applies to drinking. Food is always taken with

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the fingers, and it is considered very unbecoming for all the fingers to be put into the mouth; the first and second and thumb are used. Young people are not supposed to talk before their elders unless they are spoken to; and if anything is needed at a repast, they are expected to make themselves generally useful. When no youths are present, the women are called to fetch or take anything away, but they are required to crawl on their knees when the men are engaged in eating. It is thought the height of impropriety for a woman to convey anything to her mouth when in the presence of her husband or of any grown-up man.

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The Fors are considered by surrounding tribes to be very objectionable in their eating, as they like their food so "high." There are no traditions that cannibalism has ever prevailed in this country,  218 and the Fors speak with the greatest contempt of the Niams-Niams on account of their cannibal propensities.

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